

Senior Staff Engineer — Notification Infrastructure

Platform / Notification Infrastructure · San Francisco or Remote (US) · Full-time · L6

About the team

The Notification Infrastructure team owns the platform that delivers ~2 billion customer notifications per day across email, push, SMS, and in-app channels. We are a critical-path team for every customer-facing surface in the company; the platform's reliability is the product's reliability. The team has eleven engineers (one Junior, three Mid, four Senior, three Staff) and works closely with Applied ML, Realtime Infra, and SRE.

What you'll do

- Be the technical north star for Notification Infrastructure. There is no Principal on this team today; you set architectural direction in partnership with the broader Platform org's Principal IC.
- Lead the active rebuild of our cross-region dedup and exactly-once delivery layer. This is a multi-quarter, cross-team effort that involves Realtime Infra, SRE, and our Applied ML partners.
- Mentor our Staff and Senior engineers; run design reviews; raise the bar for what "production ready" means at our scale.
- Drive cross-team commitments. You will be the IC counterpart to the Director on cross-org initiatives and you will be expected to push back on partner teams when scope or timeline drifts.
- Own incident response leadership for the largest incidents. We expect Senior Staff ICs to be on-call once per six-week rotation and to lead post-incident reviews when warranted.

Required experience

- 8+ years of distributed systems engineering, including 3+ years operating systems at billion-events-per-day scale.
- Demonstrated technical ownership of a multi-region or globally-distributed system, including failover design and on-call leadership through real incidents.
- Strong production fluency with Kafka (or comparable event log), Redis or DynamoDB for low-latency state, and a JVM language (we are 70% Kotlin).
- A track record of cross-team leadership: holding scope across three or more partner teams, holding the line on commitments under pressure, and saying no when the right answer is no.
- Honest self-assessment of strengths and gaps. We hire ICs who say what they don't know.

Preferred

- Formal-methods exposure (TLA+, Jepsen-style testing, or equivalent).
- Experience with provider-side delivery (APNs, FCM, SES) at scale; familiarity with their quirks (e.g., FCM 503-as-soft-throttle).
- Experience integrating ML inference paths into latency-sensitive online systems.

Compensation

Base salary range for L6 Senior Staff Engineer: **\$295,000 – \$360,000**. Equity grant per company L6 standard. Sign-on bonus available based on competing offers and equity make-whole. Total comp competitive with peer companies at our stage.

How we run interviews

Recruiter screen → hiring manager → technical deep dive → system design → values → committee. Compressed pace available on request (typical 2–3 weeks). Decision is made by a hiring committee that votes on hire/no-hire and on level. Logged dissents are part of our process; we do not flatten disagreement.